

AI Visibility

PLAYBOOK

Is AI recommending your business — or ignoring it?

What Changed — And Why It Matters

Search has changed. When someone asks ChatGPT, Perplexity, Google AI, or Claude where to find a service — they don't get a list of ten blue links. They get one or two recommendations, and the AI picks them.

Most businesses are invisible to these systems — not because they're bad businesses, but because their online presence is structured for humans browsing, not for AI reading.

This playbook walks you through the five things that determine whether AI systems can find you, understand you, and recommend you.

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Built by Found For AI

The AI Visibility Checklist

Five areas that determine whether AI systems understand, trust, and recommend your business. Work through each one and note what needs fixing.

1 Entity Foundation — Who You Are

AI systems build a mental model of your business called an entity. If the basic facts are inconsistent or missing, AI can't confidently recommend you — even if you're the best option.

- ☐ **Your business name is identical everywhere**
Inconsistent names across your website, Google Business Profile, directories, and social profiles create entity confusion. AI systems discount businesses they can't verify.
- ☐ **Your address and phone number match exactly across all platforms**
NAP (Name, Address, Phone) consistency is a foundational trust signal. Even small variations — 'St.' vs 'Street' — fragment your entity in AI systems.
- ☐ **Your Google Business Profile is claimed, complete, and accurate**
GBP is one of the primary data sources AI assistants pull from. An incomplete or outdated profile is a direct reason you get skipped in AI recommendations.
- ☐ **Your website clearly states who you are, what you do, and how to contact or book**
If an AI system crawls your homepage and can't answer those three questions in the first screenful, it can't include you in a confident recommendation.

2 Structured Data Layer — What AI Actually Reads

Humans read your website. AI reads your structured data. Schema markup is the machine-readable layer that tells AI systems exactly what your business is, what it offers, and how to reach you.

- ☐ **LocalBusiness schema is implemented and matches your visible content**
This is the baseline. If your schema says one thing and your page says another, it creates a conflict AI systems resolve by trusting neither.
- ☐ **Your services or class offerings have their own schema markup**
Generic business schema isn't enough. AI needs to know specifically what you offer — service

types, formats, pricing ranges — to match you to specific queries.

- ☐ **FAQ schema is in place on your key pages**
FAQ schema is one of the most direct ways to get your exact answers surfaced in AI responses. If you're not using it, a competitor who is gets cited instead.

- ☐ **No broken or conflicting schema markup exists on the site**
Broken markup is worse than no markup. It signals to AI systems that your data layer can't be trusted, which suppresses recommendation eligibility across the board.

3 AI Crawl Blockers — What's Keeping You Invisible

You can have great content and still be invisible if technical issues prevent AI systems from reading your site. These are the blockers most businesses don't know they have.

- ☐ **Your key pages are indexed and not blocked by noindex tags or robots.txt**
Noindex tags meant for staging environments frequently end up on live pages. If AI can't crawl it, it can't cite it.

- ☐ **Your schedule, services, or events pages are crawlable and not locked behind logins or paywalls**
Critical pages that require a login to view are invisible to AI. Your public inventory needs to be publicly readable.

- ☐ **Internal links connect your homepage and top pages to your most important offers**
AI systems use your internal link structure to understand what you prioritize. If your best pages are buried, AI treats them as low-importance.

- ☐ **Your site does not have significant duplicate content or competing versions of the same page**
Duplicate pages split authority and create ambiguity about which version is authoritative — making it harder for AI to confidently recommend you.

4 Trust & Citation Signals — Why AI Should Pick You

Being findable isn't enough. AI systems also evaluate whether your business is trustworthy and worth recommending. These signals tip the scales.

- ☐ **You have recent, substantive reviews on Google and other relevant platforms**
AI systems pull review data when forming recommendations. Volume matters, but recency and specificity matter more. Generic 5-star reviews carry less weight than detailed ones.
- ☐ **Your website content answers the questions your customers actually ask**
AI systems favor businesses whose content directly answers common queries. If a customer asks 'what should I bring to my first yoga class,' your site should answer that.
- ☐ **Third-party mentions, features, or listings exist beyond your own website**
Citations from directories, press mentions, and partner sites validate your entity externally. AI systems cross-reference these to confirm you're a real, established business.
- ☐ **Credentials, certifications, or specializations are clearly stated on the site**
AI systems surface trust signals in recommendations. Unstated credentials don't help you. If it's not on the page in readable text, AI doesn't know it exists.

5 Content Clarity — Can AI Explain You to Someone Else?

The final test: if an AI system read your entire website, could it write an accurate one-paragraph description of your business and confidently recommend you for the right query? Most sites fail this test.

- ☐ **Your homepage clearly states who your business is for — not just what you do**
AI matches businesses to queries based on audience fit, not just category. 'Yoga studio' is a category. 'Yoga studio for beginners in downtown Salt Lake' is a recommendation target.
- ☐ **Each key page has a clear, specific purpose and doesn't try to do too many things**
Unfocused pages confuse AI the same way they confuse humans. A page about everything gets cited for nothing.
- ☐ **Your booking, contact, or conversion action is obvious and consistently linked**
AI systems are increasingly evaluating whether a business makes it easy to take action. Buried or broken CTAs are a soft negative signal.



You have content that answers 'why you' — not just 'what you do'

AI recommendations include context. Businesses with clear differentiation — approach, outcomes, who they serve best — get cited with more confidence than generic category matches.

How to Score Your Results

16–20 checked Strong foundation. AI systems can find and understand you. Focus on expanding trust signals and content depth.

10–15 checked Partial visibility. You're in the mix but gaps in your structured data or entity foundation are costing you recommendations.

Under 10 checked Effectively invisible to AI. The good news: most of these are fixable in one focused implementation sprint.

Found gaps you don't know how to fix?

The AI Visibility Fix is a one-time implementation that corrects your entity foundation, structured data layer, and AI crawl blockers — delivered in 7 business days.

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